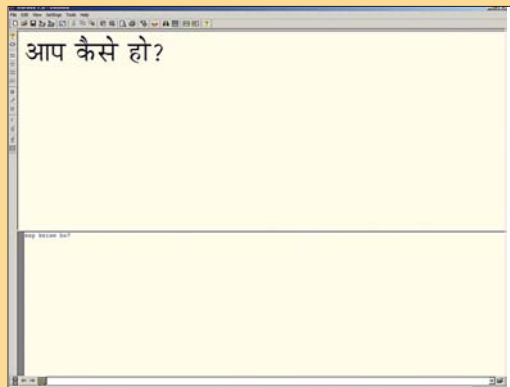




An example of using Baraha

BARAHA

www.baraha.com

If you blog at Blogger.com, you've noticed that they now let you type Indian words in their native script by spelling them in English. This is called transliteration. For example, typing in "Aap Kaise Ho?" in English will display the words in the Devanagari script. Actually, there's a simple tool that lets you use transliteration technology to type out documents in Word, chat with friends on IM, and so on—in your language. It's called Baraha.

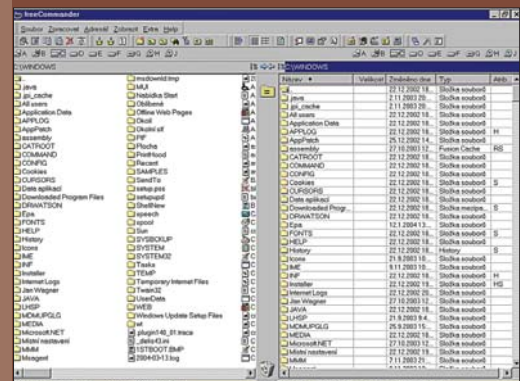
With Baraha, you don't need to remember complex keystrokes to get the correct *matra* or letter in place. Just type the words as you would pronounce them in your native language, and they will be reproduced in the correct script on-screen. Baraha supports many Indian languages, and can work with Unicode as well as TrueType fonts. Unicode fonts allow programs to change their shape, size, and rendering; these are the "weird Chinese-looking character" fonts. TrueType fonts are the ones we generally use;

they allow designers to define how their font should be rendered in any program, and they look the same on-screen and when printed.

Baraha Direct, bundled with the software, allows you to enter Indian text directly into MS Office applications and PageMaker. It's convenient—an icon in the system tray indicates the language to which the text is being transliterated. You can change the transliteration speed, change the language and change the format of the transliterated text between Unicode and TrueType.

Baraha features "learning" capabilities: it learns the spellings you use for words. For example, if you spell the Hindi word "Ma" as "Maa", Baraha can learn that—so it gets better over time at spelling your words correctly.

Note, however, that Baraha isn't quite perfect. It'll take some getting used to on your part, and some learning on the software's part.



Windows Explorer on steroids

Free Commander

www.freecommander.com

A Windows Explorer alternative that packs a punch, FreeCommander is a portable application that can be used from a CD or USB stick (or from your hard disk, of course). Copy the installation directory to the media and use the program on any computer... just like that!

FreeCommander features a dual-panel window which, divides your screen into two halves. You can open folders in both these panels. If you choose to open more windows in the panel, they are displayed under tabs. You toggle between viewing folders in a column with sub-menus, or in rows. The software can handle archives to open ZIP, CAB, and RAR files. You can also preview images just like in the Explorer shell.

Apart from the usual copy, paste, rename, move, and delete functions, FreeCommander also allows you to delete files for good (shred them). It allows you to change the attributes of any file. While running a search, the software can even look inside compressed archives.

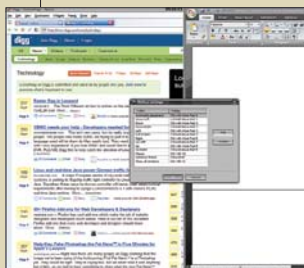
You can assign other programs to FreeCommander for opening specific file-types. For example, freeware like ATViewer, which opens image files, can be downloaded from http://www.freecommander.com/fc_utilities_en.htm.

A list of hotkeys you can use with FreeCommander can be found at http://www.freecommander.com/fc_ShortCuts_en.htm. Find FreeCommander on our March 2007 DVD. ■

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WINSPLIT REVOLUTION

<http://reptils.free.fr>



Select "Hotkey Settings" from the system tray icon to edit shortcuts

So you have this seventeen inch screen you are very happy with and you are constantly multi-tasking, opening up all those windows on the screen can be a tad confusing. WinSplit Revolution helps you align all those windows on the screen at the click of a button. Of course, you can do this manually too but using the software is much simpler!

If you still want to align your windows manually, the software allows you to snap them into place. Having said that, the auto-alignment ensures that your windows are aligned to the edge of the screen rather than "almost at

the edge". To auto align all windows, you press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [M]. To save any open program, [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [O].

A few other options include Windows Fusion, which splits the screen horizontally with the last two opened windows when the [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [F] shortcut is used. Pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [M], to use the Mosaic function, you can split the screen in nine parts and have windows in all of them. If you have less than nine windows open, some will be larger and if you have more than nine windows open, the first nine will be tiled. You can also close all windows with the shortcut [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [C]. These shortcut keys can be changed too!